

Activity 1 – Automate the Tedious

The Summariser (with a Twist)

Purpose

Use AI to draft **quick summaries** of teaching materials and then **repackage** them for different purposes (announcements, slides, quizzes). Reduce the tedious parts while keeping your professional judgement in the loop.

Core Activity (Teaching / Pedagogy)

Step 1 – Choose a short text

Pick one of the following (or use your own):

- A short reading excerpt (1–2 paragraphs)
- An assignment brief or rubric description
- A policy / guideline you want students to understand

Paste only **non-sensitive** text into the AI tool.

Step 2 – Get a basic summary

Use (or adapt) this prompt:

You are an academic in [**discipline**].

Summarise the following text for [**year level**] undergraduate students in **5–7 bullet points**.

- Use plain language and avoid unnecessary jargon.
- Highlight **2–3 key ideas** that are essential for the upcoming class.
- End with **one open question** I could use for class discussion.

Text:

[paste your text here]

Review the output. Fix obvious errors or gaps.

Step 3 – Add a “twist”

Now re-use the summary for a different teaching purpose. Choose ONE:

Option A – LMS announcement

Using the summary above, write a short **LMS announcement** for my [unit / year level] students.

- Length: **120–150 words**
- Tone: clear, supportive, and practical
- Explain *why* this reading / information matters
- End with **2 bullet points**: “Before next class, please...”

Option B – 2-slide outline

Using the summary above, create an outline for **2 PowerPoint slides** to introduce this in class.

- Slide 1: “Why this matters” – 3 bullets
- Slide 2: “Key ideas to discuss” – 3 bullets + 1 discussion question

Option C – Short quiz

Using the summary above, generate **3 multiple-choice questions** to check basic understanding.

- One clearly correct answer and three plausible distractors for each
- Label the correct answer
- Focus on understanding key ideas, not trivial details

Step 4 – Human in the loop

Ask yourself:

- Does this output say what I actually need it to say?
- What do I need to **edit, add, or remove**?
- Do I keep refining this, change direction with a new prompt, or start over?

Remember: AI is for **first drafts and ideas**. You decide what happens next.

Variants for Researchers and Professional Staff

You can use the same pattern (summarise → twist) for non-teaching work.

If you are mainly doing research

Try one of these:

- Summarise a **journal article abstract** →
 - Twist: “Rewrite for a **non-technical audience** (e.g., impact statement or lay summary).”
- Summarise **reviewer comments** →
 - Twist: “Draft a **polite response letter** that groups comments by theme and proposes how I will address them.”
- Summarise a **methods section** →
 - Twist: “Create a **5-bullet checklist** for running this procedure in the lab / field.”

If you are in a professional / administrative role

Try one of these:

- Summarise part of a **policy or procedure** →
 - Twist: “Turn this into a **student-facing FAQ** with 5–7 questions and clear answers.”
 - Summarise a **meeting paper or report** →
 - Twist: “Draft a **staff bulletin** or **internal email** with key decisions and actions.”
 - Summarise a **web page or form instructions** →
 - Twist: “Rewrite as **step-by-step instructions** for students or staff.”
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Reflection / Notes

Use the prompts below and the space provided.

- What tedious part of your work did AI reduce in this activity?
- What did you still need to change as the domain expert?
- Where could this summarise + twist pattern fit in your unit, project, or role?

(Notes:)

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